

Four Syllable Words with Stress on the First, Second and Third Syllable.

A syllable is a word or that part of a word which represent the minimum unit of pronunciation; it contains one vowel sound and may be preceded or followed by one or more consonants.

Stress on the other hand is the emphasis or force that one syllable carries in a word or sentence. In other words, stress is the degree of force with which a syllable is uttered. When the degree of force is high, we say the syllable is stressed, but when the degree of force is low, we say that the syllable is unstressed.

Syllables stressed on first, second and third syllable are not always easy to identify the syllable that is stressed. Therefore the following rules will be used as a guide:

Most 4 syllable words that end in ... ABLE have their primary stress on the first syllable.

Examples:

Lamentable LA-men-ta-ble

Applicable AP-pli-ca-ble

lamentable LA-men-ta-ble

Most 4 syllable words that end in... ATE have their primary stress on the second syllable.

Examples:

Communicate com-MU-ni-cate

Comfortable COM-for-ta-ble

Admirable AD-mi-ra-ble

Eradicate e-RA-di-cate

Accelerate a-CE-re-late

Articulate ar-TI-cu-late

Congratulate con-GRA-tu-late

on the second syllable.

Most 4 syllable words that end in ... LITY... SITY... MITY/...NITY have their primary stress

Examples:



Calamity ca-LA-mi-ty

Totality to-TA-li-ty

Fidelity fi-DE-li-ty

Finality fi-NA-li-ty

Maternity ma-TER-ni-ty

Pomposity pom-PO-si-ty

Most 4 syllable words that end in. ARY have their primary stress on the second syllable.

Examples:

Judiciary ju-DI-cia-ry

Obituary o-BI-tua-ry

Most 4 syllable words that end in ... TIVE have their primary stress on the second syllable.

Examples:

Evocative E-VO-ca-tive

Affirmative A-FIRR-ma-tive

Demonstrative de-MONS-tra-tive

Most 4 syllable words that end in... NAL have their primary stress on the second syllable.

Examples: Professional pro-FES-sio-nal

Additional ad-DI-tio-nal

Occasional oc-CA-sio-nal

Rotational ro-TA-tio-nal

Intentional in-TEN-tio-nal

Most 4 syllable words that end in ... TION have their primary stress on the third syllable.

Examples:

Federation fe-de-RA-tion

Jubilation ju-bi-LA-tion



Institution ins-ti-TU-tion

Population po-pù-LA-tion

Most 4 syllable words that end in ... TIC have their primary stress on the third syllable.

Examples:

Democratic de-mo-CRA-tic

Automatic au-to-CRA-tic

Systematic sys-te-MA-tic

Diplomatic di-plo-MA-tic

Energetic e-ne-GE-tic.

